Off-Market Sourcing System

Market: _____ **Date:** _____

Part A: Before you fall for anything.

Takes in: county records and license lists.

Hands to: AS-03.

Roughly 4,500 parks sit in small markets, and most of their owners never list. The buyer who finds the park before the broker package exists negotiates with the owner, not the market.

1. Where the names come from

- ☐ County tax assessor records: filter by use code, absentee owners, and long hold times. Cross off anything already listed.
- ☐ In states that license parks, the license list shows owner names. Not every state licenses. Check yours.
- ☐ Utility hookup counts from the water district: a second read on occupancy, straight from the meter.
- ☐ Drive the market and log every park you pass. Condition from the road goes in the notes. Street photos only, from public roads.
- ☐ Eviction court filings: tired landlords show up in the docket before they show up in a listing.
- ☐ Permit office: parks pulling no permits for years can mean deferred work, or an owner done investing. Either way, a conversation starter.

2. Score the list before you mail

Score every park 1 to 5 on three signals: owner distance (absentee scores high), hold length (10-plus years scores high), distress (dockets, condition, no permits). Mail the high scorers first.

The scoring is a rule of thumb, verify locally. Your county sets the cutoffs.

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3. The owner letter: one page, no wholesaler energy

Plain paper, hand-addressed envelope, no logos, no urgency, no cash-offer language, no 'we buy parks'.

"Dear [owner name],"

"I live in [town] and I am looking to buy one small park nearby to operate for the long term. I drove past [park name] and wanted to ask if you have ever thought about selling."

"I am not a wholesaler and I will not flip your park to someone else. If you are open to a conversation, I will come to you, on your schedule."

"[Your name], [phone number]"

One letter never closes. The follow-up does. Plan four touches before you call a name cold.

4. Follow-up cadence tracker

Owner / park	Letter sent	Touch 2 (+30d)	Touch 3 (+60d)	Touch 4 (+90d)	Response

Touch 2 is a second letter. Touch 3 is a postcard. Touch 4 is a phone call. Log every touch the day you make it.

Touch 4: Check local rules on solicitation and calling before you dial.

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Worked example

Fictional example. The arithmetic below is the point, not the numbers: run your own market through the same funnel.

The buyer builds a list in Maple Bend Estates' county. The county license list shows 14 parks (fictional county data).

Step	Math	Result
Licensed parks in the county (fictional)		14
Minus: already listed or broker-known		3
Minus: owner-occupied or too small		2
Target list	14 - 3 - 2	9
Touch 1: letters sent		9
Touch 2: second letter at +30 days		9
Touch 3: postcard at +60 days		9
Touch 4: call at +90 days	check local rules first	9 attempted
Responses		2
Response rate	2 / 9	22%
Meetings set		1

The meeting came from a touch-3 postcard. One letter never closes. The follow-up does.

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The Doctrine

The belief this tool shatters is that the listed market is the whole market. It is not. Most small parks never list. They trade when an owner gets ready and a known buyer is already in front of them. The one rule: the list is the asset, and you build it yourself, one county record and one letter at a time. Wholesaler letters get shredded. An owner-to-owner letter from a local who plans to hold for decades gets read. Four touches beat one letter. The follow-up is the whole strategy. A list you build is a pipeline you own. A list you buy is a list everyone owns.

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